

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-16

Cost Baseline and Funding Requirements

The approved time-phased budget and the funding needed to meet it

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Cost Baseline and Funding Requirements
Document reference	PMB-16-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor and finance
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-15	Cost Estimates and Basis of Estimates	Input to the baseline
PMB-29	Earned Value Analysis Report	Measures against this baseline
PMB-14	Cost Management Plan	Governs this baseline

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Records the approved time-phased cost baseline against which performance is measured, the contingency and management reserve held above it, and the funding requirements including any funding limit reconciliation.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Cost Management — Determine Budget
Created when	During planning, after estimating
Reviewed / updated	Through change control only
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor and finance
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	The relationship between baseline, contingency and management reserve is often misunderstood. State it explicitly here — the cost baseline includes contingency but excludes management reserve.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- The baseline is time-phased, not a single total
- Contingency is inside the baseline; management reserve is outside it
- Funding requirements account for the gap between spend and funding tranches
- Control accounts map to the WBS and to finance coding
- The approval and version of the baseline are unambiguous

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1. Baseline summary

Component	Amount	Notes
Work package cost estimates	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation
Contingency reserve	AED 9,400,000, derived from expected value of identified risks; drawn by the Programme Manager against a named risk	For identified risks; within the cost baseline
Cost baseline	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	Estimates plus contingency
Management reserve	AED 5,200,000, held outside the cost baseline and released by the SRO only	For unidentified risk; outside the baseline
Total project budget	AED 176,600,000	Cost baseline plus management reserve

2. Time-phased baseline

Period	Planned value	Cumulative PV	Funding available	Cumulative funding	Variance
Sep 2026	AED 4,200,000	AED 4,200,000	AED 4,200,000	AED 4,200,000	-AED 130,000
Oct 2026	AED 11,600,000	AED 11,600,000	AED 11,600,000	AED 11,600,000	-AED 380,000
Nov 2026	AED 23,400,000	AED 23,400,000	AED 23,400,000	AED 23,400,000	-AED 800,000
Dec 2026	AED 38,900,000	AED 38,900,000	AED 38,900,000	AED 38,900,000	-AED 1,200,000
Jan 2027	AED 52,700,000	AED 52,700,000	AED 52,700,000	AED 52,700,000	-AED 1,100,000
Feb 2027	AED 66,100,000	AED 66,100,000	AED 66,100,000	AED 66,100,000	-AED 800,000

3. Budget by control account

Control account	WBS elements	Budget	Owner	Finance code	Measurement method
1.0 Programme management	1.0 Programme management	AED 5,900,000	D. Okonkwo, Programme	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account

Control account	WBS elements	Budget	Owner	Finance code	Measurement method
			Manager		level
2.0 Facilities and power	2.0 Facilities and power	AED 18,200,000	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account level
3.0 Compute and storage	3.0 Compute and storage	AED 28,400,000	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account level
4.0 Network fabric	4.0 Network fabric	AED 8,600,000	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account level
5.0 Platform and orchestration	5.0 Platform and orchestration	AED 2,400,000	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account level
6.0 MLOps and developer experience	6.0 MLOps and developer experience	AED 900,000	N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account level
7.0 Security and compliance	7.0 Security and compliance	AED 1,400,000	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account level
8.0 Service operations readiness	8.0 Service operations readiness	AED 300,000	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	GT-INF-HEL	Milestone weighting at control account level

4. Budget by category and year

Category	Capex / Opex	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
Accelerator hardware	Capex	AED 980,000	AED 252,000	AED 378,000	AED 91,200,000
Storage and parallel filesystem	Capex	AED 238,000	AED 3,220,000	AED 2,940,000	AED 17,800,000
Network fabric	Capex	AED 2,870,000	AED 1,246,000	AED 37,380,000	AED 13,600,000
Facilities — power, cooling, structural	Capex	AED 434,000	AED 12,040,000	AED 8,610,000	AED 24,300,000
Platform software and licences	Opex	AED 6,020,000	AED 868,000	AED 1,302,000	AED 6,800,000
Integration partner services	Opex	AED 623,000	AED 5,740,000	AED 18,060,000	AED 11,200,000
Internal labour	Opex	AED	AED 476,000	AED	AED 8,400,000

Category	Capex / Opex	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
		12,460,000		1,869,000	
Security assurance and testing	Opex	AED 980,000	AED 3,220,000	AED 37,380,000	AED 1,900,000

5. Funding requirements and limit reconciliation

Where funding is released in tranches, show where cumulative spend would exceed cumulative funding and what has been done about it.

Tranche	Amount	Available from	Conditions	Reconciliation action
Tranche 1	AED 91,200,000	15 Dec 2026	Applies to all workloads on the DXB-1 estate without exception	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026
Tranche 2	AED 17,800,000	31 Jan 2027	Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only	Confirm vendor allocation in writing before placing the structural order
Tranche 3	AED 13,600,000	26 Feb 2027	Delegated to the Programme Manager within tolerance; above tolerance to the Programme Board	Broker all vendor access through the monitored in-country jump host
Tranche 1	AED 24,300,000	31 Mar 2027	Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry	Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop
Tranche 2	AED 6,800,000	23 Apr 2027	Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only	Engage vendor performance engineering for two weeks per hall
Tranche 3	AED 11,200,000	28 May 2027	Applies to all workloads on the DXB-1 estate without exception	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026

6. Reserve drawdown log

Date	Reserve type	Amount	Reason	Risk ref	Approved by	Remaining
23 Apr 2027	Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026	AED 17,800,000	Consolidation is the primary source of the benefit case; utilisation across siloed estates averages 31%	Scarce platform engineering skills extend contract or dependence (RSK-004)	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	0

Date	Reserve type	Amount	Reason	Risk ref	Approved by	Remaining
31 Mar 2027	Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance	AED 1,120,000	Physical lead times do not tolerate emerging requirements, so this element is frozen before order	Weak tenant isolation exposes model weights across business units (RSK-003)	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement	2
26 Feb 2027	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)	AED 91,200,000	Grid capacity at DXB-1 supports Tranche 2 in full, so a second site is not yet justified	Scarce platform engineering skills extend contract or dependence (RSK-004)	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	1
31 Jan 2027	Reflected in the solution intent as a fixed constraint	AED 4,200,000	Air cooling would cap density at 12 kW per rack and require 2.4 times the floor area	Weak tenant isolation exposes model weights across business units (RSK-003)	I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead	3

7. Baseline approval and change history

Version	Date	Amount	Reason for change	Change request ref	Approved by
v0.1	04 Jun 2026	AED 4,200,000	Initial draft for workstream review	Initial draft for workstream review	—
v0.2	21 Jul 2026	AED 96,000	Updated following workstream lead review and CISO comments	Updated following workstream lead review and CISO comments	—
v0.3	25 Aug 2026	AED 11,200,000	Cost figures aligned to the definitive estimate	Cost figures aligned to the definitive	—

Version	Date	Amount	Reason for change	Change request ref	Approved by
				estimate	
v1.0	18 Sep 2026	AED 240,000	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate	R. Al Mazrouei